AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University
Egypt

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

TR103
Contrastive Analysis
All Branches
MTA Exam/ Main

Spring 2024-25

Date: 9 April 2025
5:00 – 6:30

Number of Exam Pages: 3 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 1.5 hours**

INSTRUCTION

1. Read the questions carefully before you answer.
2. Answer all the questions in the answer booklet.
3. Write all your answers in ink NOT pencil.
4. Edit and proofread your language.

Total Grade: 30

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Question 1 (10 marks)

Choose the correct answer:

1. **Why is it important to identify the propositional meaning in translation?**
   a) To understand the emotional tone
   b) To ensure the core message is conveyed
   c) To replicate the author's style
   d) To address cultural differences

2. **Which of the following is an example of dialectal variation that might affect translation?**
   a) The use of "lift" in British English vs. "elevator" in American English
   b) The use of formal vs. informal language
   c) The use of idioms
   d) The use of technical jargon

3. **When translating a legal document, which register should be used?**
   a) Formal
   b) Informal
   c) Neutral
   d) It depends on the target audience

4. **When translating collocations, a translator should:**
   a) Translate each word separately
   b) Find an equivalent collocation in the target language
   c) Use a literal translation
   d) Omit the collocation

5. **In translation, marked collocations might be used to:**
   a) Create a specific effect or emphasis
   b) Confuse the reader
   c) Simplify the language
   d) Avoid cultural references

6. **When encountering a culture-specific item, a translator might:**
   a) Use a literal translation
   b) Use a cultural substitution
   c) Leave it in the source language
   d) All of the above, depending on the context

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7. **Cultural substitution is appropriate when:**
   a) The culture-specific item has no equivalent
   b) The item is crucial to the meaning
   c) The item is well-known in the target culture
   d) The item is too complex

8. **If a source text uses "slim" to describe a person positively, the translation should:**
   a) Use a word with similar positive connotations
   b) Use a neutral word like "thin"
   c) Use a negative word to contrast
   d) Omit the description

9. **Why is evoked meaning challenging in translation?**
   a) It depends on shared cultural knowledge
   b) It can be ambiguous
   c) It may not have a direct equivalent in the target language
   d) All of the above

10. **Which of the following is the most appropriate Arabic equivalent for the English term "Dry Book"?**
    a) كتاب جاف
    b) كتاب ممل
    c) كتاب علمي
    d) كتاب بدون صور

Question 2 (20 marks)

Translate the following text into Arabic and in an essay of 200-250 words try to describe the negotiation process as you deal with the problems of equivalence and non-equivalence. Your knowledge of the topics presented in your textbook (*In Other Words*) should illuminate your treatment of the problems you encounter.

My sister and I went to New Orleans for a big party called Mardi Gras. It was great! We heard music in the streets. We smelled yummy food like soup. People said, "Have fun!" and smiled a lot. We walked in a place with old houses and pretty balconies. The music was loud and happy. It made us smile too. The day was hot, but we liked it. We ate sweet food called beignets. They had sugar on top and tasted so good! We got messy, but it was fun. New Orleans is a cool place. We want to go back one day.

Best wishes

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